



KRISHNA MURARI KISHAN

RAY HOPES THAT THE MACHINE WILL INCREASE INCOMES OF THE USERS BY UP TO 30 PER CENT.

people," he reminisces.

During his posting at one of the poorest tribal villages, Ray learned how PRADAN assisted the Union Ministry of Rural Development and the CSB—which provided funds and technology—to create sustainable livelihood for the village poor. The medium was promoting tasar silk-worm rearing and tasar yarn production. Eventually Ray's drive and commitment impressed everyone in the or-

ganisation. When PRADAN decided to constitute MASUTA Producers Company Limited to focus on collective production of tasar yarns with rural women yarn producers as owners in December 2005, Ray was the consensus pick as the managing director.

Today, MASUTA has 2,500 rural women yarn producers, an annual turnover of Rs 13 crore and is growing every year with women from disadvantaged rural families from Bihar, Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh as shareholders. Provided with productive assets for yarn-making like reeling machines, these women have gained control over their own earnings and become an economically empowered lot. Ray has played a pioneering role in making the machine a viable business model. He's reeling in the accolades now. ■

little by little
you can achieve a lot



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